

Living Beyond SCI

A free, self-directed resource you can hand to a patient — on discharge, in a resource folder, or at a rehabilitation centre noticeboard.

"What helps people not just survive spinal cord injury, but flourish?" — this website brings together twenty years of work addressing that question, across research, music, and mind-body practice.

What the site offers

PILLAR ONE Quality of Life Research

Graduate quality-of-life research from Deakin University, under Prof Robert Cummins, in plain language for patients and families.

PILLAR TWO Hands-Free Harmonica

A breath-powered harmonica curriculum for people with high-level injuries and little or no hand function.

PILLAR THREE Guided Imagery Programme

Five audio-guided practices — hand and grasp, bladder, bowel, spasticity, sexual sensation — grounded in motor imagery research.

FRAMING YOU CAN RELY ON

Nothing on this site claims to cure or reverse spinal cord injury. The Guided Imagery Programme draws on peer-reviewed motor imagery research, but its three-phase method is the author's own synthesis and hasn't been clinically tested as a unified protocol — stated plainly on every practice page.

The practices complement prescribed care rather than replace it; patients are directed to continue any existing medication, device, or treatment.

About the author

Jeremy Olson holds a Masters of Social Sciences (Psychology) from Waikato University, NZ. His graduate SCI research was conducted at Deakin University under Prof Robert Cummins. He is not a clinician and does not have SCI himself — the site is built as a researcher and educator working alongside people who do.

Why teams hand this out

- Free — no login, paywall, or cost to the patient
- Self-directed — any pace, any device
- Honest about what is and isn't proven
- Useful for patients and the people around them